

The 'Show Me It's Gentle' Script Bank

By the time you finish this document you will know precisely what the Settling Sequence Reset involves at every stage — what the baby does, what you do, and when you step in — so that when 7pm arrives and your body says "just pick her up," you have something concrete to hold onto instead of doubt.

HOW TO USE THIS

This is your 'Show Me It's Gentle' Script Bank — a post-enrolment reference document you use before your first settling session to replace uncertainty with clarity. It contains word-for-word questions to interrogate any sleep approach (including this one), a plain-language real-time breakdown of exactly what the Settling Sequence Reset looks and sounds like minute by minute, and a side-by-side comparison format so you can see for yourself — not take anyone's word for it. Read the breakdown first, then use the comparison table, then keep the confidence script on your phone for night one.

SCRIPT

The 'Show Me It's Gentle' Question Script

Use this word-for-word to interrogate any sleep method — including this one — before or during your onboarding call. Read each question aloud, fill in the answers you hear, and trust what the evidence tells you.

The 'Show Me It's Gentle' Question Script

Use these questions with any sleep consultant — including your Sleep Reset for New Parents consultant — to surface exactly what their method involves. Fill in the **[ANSWER]** field as you go. If a consultant cannot answer any of these clearly, that tells you something important.

SECTION 1 — What Actually Happens to My Baby

Q1. When my baby cries during settling, what specifically do I do first?

Answer: **[ANSWER]**

Q2. How long, in minutes, does my baby cry before I respond — at any stage of the method?

Answer: [ANSWER]

Q3. Is there any stage in this method where I leave the room while my baby is in active, distressed crying and do not return until a timer runs out?

Answer: [ANSWER]

Q4. What does 'responding' look like — do I pick up, do I touch, do I use my voice only, or something else?

Answer: [ANSWER]

Q5. Will my baby cry at all? If yes — what kind of crying is expected, what kind is a signal to stop, and how do I tell the difference?

Answer: [ANSWER]

SECTION 2 — What the Method Actually Is

Q6. Can you describe what the first 20 minutes of night one looks like — what I do, what the baby does, step by step?

Answer: [ANSWER]

Q7. Is there a timed interval where I delay responding? If yes, what is the interval on night one?

Answer: [ANSWER]

Q8. Does this method involve any version of Ferber, Weissbluth, extinction, or graduated extinction — even rebranded?

Answer: [ANSWER]

Q9. What is the role of feeding in the settling process — does it stop immediately, reduce gradually, or stay in place while sleep associations shift?

Answer: [ANSWER]

Q10. If my baby is still crying intensely after [15] minutes, what is my instruction?

Answer: [ANSWER]

SECTION 3 — What 'Gentle' Actually Means Here

Q11. How do you define 'gentle' — and what would make a method cross the line into 'not gentle' by your definition?

Answer: [ANSWER]

Q12. At what point in the process is a parent physically present with the baby?

Answer: [ANSWER]

Q13. What does week three look like compared to night one — what has changed for the baby?

Answer: [ANSWER]

HOW TO SCORE WHAT YOU HEAR

WHAT YOU HEARD	WHAT IT SIGNALS
Clear, specific answers to Q1, Q4, Q6	Method is transparent — good sign
Timed intervals where you <i>don't</i> respond to active distress	Graduated extinction — not the same as gentle
"It depends" or vague language for Q3 and Q7	Ask again. Vagueness here is not neutral.
Feeding role is explained clearly (Q9)	Consultant understands associations, not just schedules

WHAT YOU HEARD

WHAT IT SIGNALS

Cannot describe night one step by step
(Q6)

Method is not codified — carry on with
caution

SOP

The Settling Sequence Reset: Real-Time Breakdown

Read this before your first settling session so you know exactly what to expect — what your baby does, what you do, and when you respond — at every stage. This is the plain-language version of the method you've enrolled in.

The Settling Sequence Reset — Plain-Language Real-Time Breakdown

What this is: A minute-by-minute account of what the Settling Sequence Reset looks and sounds like in your baby's room on a real night. No jargon. No 'trust the process' without knowing what the process is.

The Core Principle (20-word version)

Your baby learns to fall asleep without needing to be fed, rocked, or held — while you remain present and responsive throughout.

 **Cry-it-out means:** leaving the room and not returning until a set timer ends, regardless of distress level.

 **The Settling Sequence Reset means:** staying in or near the room, responding to distress cues before they escalate, and gradually shifting the conditions your baby associates with sleep — over days, not one brutal night.

Stage 1 — The Wind-Down Window (20–30 minutes before target sleep time)

What you do:

- Dim the lights in the room to near-darkness
- Run the same short sequence every night: [bath or warm cloth wipe] → [feed — but not to full sleep] → [into sleep sack] → [white noise on] → [one short phrase said the same way every night, e.g. "Time to sleep, I'm right here"]
- Feed ends while baby is **drowsy but still awake** — eyes open, slowing down, but not fully out

What your baby does:

- May root for more feed — this is normal, it does not mean she is still hungry
- Eyes may be half-open, body goes heavy
- Some babies grizzle softly at this stage — this is protest, not distress

Your response:

- Place her in the cot on her back while she is still conscious
- Keep your hand on her chest for 10–15 seconds, then slowly lift it
- Stay in the room

Stage 2 — The First Protest Phase (0–5 minutes after going into cot)

What your baby does:

- Eyes open fully — she realises she is in the cot and not in your arms
- Grizzling begins, may escalate to crying — this is *protest crying*, not distress crying (see the difference below)
- Body may stiffen, arms may flail

What you do:

- **Do not pick up immediately.** Wait for a genuine distress signal (see below)
- Use your voice first: *"I'm here, I've got you, it's sleep time"* — calm, low, the same words
- If grizzling continues past 2 minutes without escalating to distress: place one hand firmly on her chest, apply gentle steady pressure, keep voice low
- If it escalates to distress crying: pick up, hold upright, calm to the point of drowsy-but-awake, then replace in cot

Protest crying vs. distress crying — how to tell:

PROTEST CRYING

Rhythmic, has a pattern

Pauses when you speak or touch

Baby's body is stiff but not arching

Peaks then reduces within 3–5 min

This is expected — stay with it

DISTRESS CRYING

Escalating, no pause to breathe

Continues or intensifies when you touch

Baby arches away from you

Does not reduce — keeps climbing

This is your signal to pick up

Stage 3 — The Settling Window (5–20 minutes)

What your baby does:

- Protest crying reduces in waves — you will notice it gets quieter, then loud again, then quieter
- Eyes begin to lose focus
- Body starts to release tension

What you do:

- Remain in the room — you can sit in a chair near the cot, you do not have to stand over her
 - Continue voice cues on the protest spikes: *"I'm here, sleep time"*
 - Every time she escalates to distress (arching, breath-hold): pick up, calm to drowsy, replace — there is no limit on how many times you do this on night one
 - **Do not:** re-feed to full sleep, rock to full sleep, or bring her out of the room
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Stage 4 — The Drop (this is what you are working towards)

What your baby does:

- Eyes close fully
- Body goes completely limp — the 'heavy baby' feeling
- Breathing slows and deepens
- She has fallen asleep **without being fed or rocked to sleep**

What you do:

- Wait 3–5 minutes before leaving the room — sudden movement can rouse a light-sleep phase
 - Leave slowly
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What Changes Over Three Weeks

NIGHT	WHAT TO EXPECT
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Night 1–2	Longest protest phase. You will be in the room. This is normal and does not mean it isn't working.
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Night 3–5	Protest phase shortens noticeably. She goes into the cot and the window to the drop closes faster.
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NIGHT	WHAT TO EXPECT
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Week 2	Most families see the first 4–6 hour stretch. She still protests, but it resolves faster.
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Week 3	She goes down with minimal protest. The sequence itself becomes the sleep cue.
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The One Thing to Hold Onto on Night One

The goal of night one is not that she sleeps through. The goal is that she falls asleep in her cot, with you present, without being fed or rocked to full sleep. That is the entire win for night one. Everything else is built on that.

TEMPLATE

Side-by-Side Method Comparison Template

Fill in the left column with any other approach you've read about (e.g. Ferber, Shuffle, Chair Method, pick-up-put-down) and compare it directly to the Settling Sequence Reset using the criteria that matter most to you.

Side-by-Side Method Comparison Template

How to use: Fill in **[OTHER METHOD]** with any approach you have read about — Ferber, Sleep Lady Shuffle, Chair Method, pick-up-put-down, extinction. Use your answers from the Question Script (Tool 1) to populate the Settling Sequence Reset column. Trust what the comparison shows you.

The Comparison Table

CRITERIA	[OTHER METHOD NAME]	SETTLING SEQUENCE RESET
Is a parent present in the room during settling?	[YES / NO / SOMETIMES]	Yes — parent stays in or immediately outside the room throughout
Is there a timed interval where you don't respond?	[YES — e.g. 3/5/10 min intervals / NO]	No — response is cue-based, not timer-based
When does the parent respond to crying?	[AFTER X MINUTES / ONLY AT END OF INTERVAL]	When crying escalates to distress signals (arching, no pause, breath-hold)
Is picking up allowed?	[YES / NO / ONLY BEFORE X WEEKS]	Yes — picking up to calm to drowsy-but-awake is built into the method
What is the role of feeding?	[REMOVED IMMEDIATELY / GRADUAL REDUCTION / KEPT IN PLACE]	Feed continues but ends at drowsy-not-asleep; association shifts gradually
What does the baby experience on night one?	[ALONE IN ROOM / PARENT PRESENT / PARTIAL PRESENCE]	Parent physically present; baby is never left in distress without a response
How long until results are expected?	[X NIGHTS / X WEEKS]	Most families see a 4–6 hour stretch by the end of week two
What kind of crying is expected?	[NONE / SOME PROTEST / SIGNIFICANT DISTRESS]	Protest crying expected; distress crying is the signal to respond, not wait
Is this a version of cry-it-out or graduated extinction?	[YES / NO / REBRANDED VERSION]	No — no timed non-response intervals; parent responds to distress throughout
What does 'success' look like at week	[DESCRIBE]	Baby goes down awake with minimal protest; sleeps a

CRITERIA

[OTHER METHOD NAME]

SETTLING SEQUENCE RESET

three?

continuous 6-hour stretch

Your Verdict

After filling this in, answer these three questions in your own words:

1. Is the Settling Sequence Reset different from cry-it-out in a way that is concrete and specific, not just a relabelling?

[YOUR ANSWER]

2. Is there anything in the breakdown (Tool 2) that you did not expect or that you need clarified before night one?

[YOUR ANSWER — and bring this question to your onboarding call]

3. On a scale of 1–10, how confident are you in what you will do at the first protest cry on night one?

Score: — If this is below 7, re-read Stage 2 of the Real-Time Breakdown and note what specifically is still unclear.

CHECKLIST

Night-One Confidence Checklist

Run through this at 6:30pm on your first settling night — before the baby goes into the wind-down window — so you go in with a clear head, not a panicking one.

Night-One Confidence Checklist

Run this at 6:30pm — before the wind-down window starts. Tick each item. If anything is unticked, resolve it before 7pm.

Environment ✓

- ☐ Room is dark enough that you can barely see your hand in front of you
 - ☐ White noise machine is on and set to a consistent level (aim for around 65dB — roughly the sound of a shower)
 - ☐ Sleep sack is laid out and ready
 - ☐ Your phone is on silent and face-down — you do not need it in the room
 - ☐ A chair or low seat is positioned near (not directly over) the cot so you can sit during the settling window without hovering
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Your Head ✓

- ☐ I know the difference between protest crying and distress crying (if not, re-read Stage 2 of the Breakdown now)
 - ☐ I know my one response phrase and I can say it in a calm, low voice: *"I'm here, I've got you, it's sleep time"* (or your chosen phrase — write it here:)
 - ☐ I know that picking her up is allowed — and that doing so is part of the method, not a failure
 - ☐ I know the goal for tonight is **not** a full night's sleep — it is that she falls asleep in her cot, awake when she goes in, with me present. That is the win.
 - ☐ I have told my partner what stage I am at and what I need from them (are they in the room with me, outside the door, handling the monitor?)
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Your Body ✓

- ☐ I have eaten something in the last two hours — even something small
- ☐ I have had water
- ☐ I have gone to the bathroom

- ☐ I have taken three slow breaths in the last five minutes
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Your Plan for If It Feels Impossible ✓

- ☐ I know my 'pause point': if I feel I am about to override the method, I will [sit down in the chair / text my partner to come in / say my phrase out loud to myself] before I act
 - ☐ I have read the 'What to Hold Onto on Night One' section in the Breakdown and I know what the actual win looks like tonight
 - ☐ I know that every pick-up to calm her back to drowsy is correct — there is no limit
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The One Sentence to Say to Yourself When It Gets Hard

"She is protesting the change, not suffering from it. I am here. I am responding. This is working."

After night one, note these three things before you go to sleep:

1. How long from cot to drop? ☐ minutes
2. How many pick-ups did I do? ☐
3. What did she do that I didn't expect? ☐

Bring these notes to your next check-in — they are your baseline data for tracking progress over three weeks.

YOUR NEXT STEP

You Know What It Is — Now Go Do Night One

You have the breakdown, the comparison, and the checklist. The next step is inside your Sleep Reset for New Parents programme: your onboarding call or Step 1 of the core sequence, where you set your baby's specific sleep window, confirm her current wake windows, and lock in your personalised Settling Sequence plan before night one. Bring your completed comparison table and any unanswered questions from the Question Script — your consultant will close the gaps so you go into the first night with a 10/10 confidence score, not a 6.

[Go to Step 1: Set Your Settling Plan](#)